
Evaluating and Why

You have reached the top: the final result of the project. Now it's time to look back and evaluate together.

When you evaluate, you gather information, analyze it, and assess its value, effectiveness, or quality (Scriven, 1967).

By evaluating, you gain more insight into the strengths and weaknesses of the process and discover what can be improved in next project. You might also formulate the justification of what you have accomplished together and find out how you want to grow further and develop personally.

What to evaluate?

Mostly, the different team members want to emphasis different aspects from the project during the evaluation. For example, students and teachers are likely to

focus more on student outcomes in terms of grades and study progress. A policymaker or NGO might prefer to evaluate the results of solutions to the complex problem. Don't forget the more intangible results such as the development of competencies of all team members, the emotional experience of the collaboration process, and the project's spin-off effects.

In a good evaluation, these different outcomes should coexist and valued equally.